

Yarkhandi plou

Artisanal Alchemy

WHERE: Leh, Ladakh

WHO: Chef Kunzes Angmo, culinary researcher and documenter of Ladakhi food culture, introduces small groups of guests to authentic flavours of the region at her family home called Jade House in Chubi

WHY: A chance to try stinging nettle soup, smokey sourdough called *khambir*, tartlets made of black buckwheat and sun-dried *churpey* cheese, homemade *khagla* butter, and *sgnam thuk*, a hearty broth made from goat trotters and shanks, Yarkhandi pulao which is made with Afghan raisins, sweet apricot kernels, and tenderised meat, and many more, in a three-hour feast that feeds your body even as it nourishes your soul with the stories behind each dish

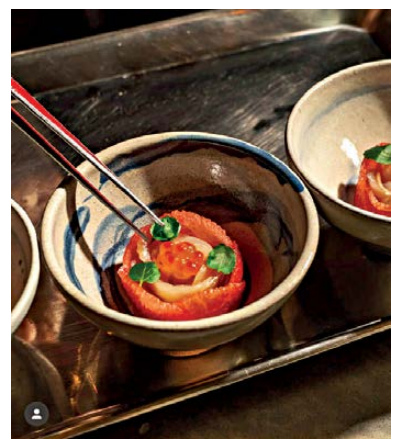
HOW: Flight to Leh

Artisanal Alchemy's Ladakhi dinner spread





Chef Hussain Shahzad (second from right); (below, L-R) his crafty take on rasam and chhena poda





Papa's Bombay

WHERE: Mumbai, Maharashtra

WHO: The inimitable Chef Hussain Shahzad, who has swept all the awards of late, and the team at Hunger Inc, the people behind The Bombay Canteen, O Pedro, Bombay Sweet Shop, and Veronica's

WHY: To get a front-row seat to the chef's artistry at his irreverent 12-seater tucked away in Bandra's Ranwar village. The 10-course menu is filled with surprises, potato chips with truffle, lemon and Champagne, a hat-tip to Chinese darsan; his crafty take on rasam—which involves cured trout and lime leaf oil; or a Maharashtrian modak filled with char siu pork instead of coconut. The meal is accompanied by plenty of madness, puzzles, group cheers, impromptu pours from a hip flask, and wine pairings by General Manager Madhusudan Kashyap

HOW: Flight to Mumbai